

puter viruses that attack antivirus products are sometimes referred to as retro-viruses.

Real-time Scanner

An anti-virus software application that operates as a background task, allowing the computer to continue working at normal speed, with no perceptible slowing.

Redirect

The action used by some viruses to point a command to a different location. Often this different location is the address of the virus and not the original file or application.

Rename

The action by which a user or program assigns a new name to a file. Viruses may rename program files and take the name of the file so running the program inadvertently runs the virus.

Replication

The process by which a virus makes copies of itself in order to carry out subsequent infections. Replication is one of major criteria separating viruses from other computer programs.

Resident Extension

A resident extension is a memory-resident portion of a program that remains active after the program ends. It essentially becomes an extension to the operating system. Many viruses install themselves as resident extensions.

ROM, Read-Only Memory

Apart from its contents normally not being modifiable, ROM is usually also non-volatile. This type of memory is traditionally used to hold a PC's BIOS and little else, although various kinds of 'modifiable ROM' memory technologies, such as EPROM, EEPROM and flash memory, have been used through the years, with flash memory being preferred in recent years.